HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I can't be happy until my parents change"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I can't be happy until my parents change." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ How long have I waited?
- ☐ What has waiting cost me?
- ☐ What is mine to control?
- ☐ What can bring joy now?
- ☐ What limits do I need?
- ☐ What would contentment look like?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ My happiness is not in their hands.
- ☐ Each person answers to God for their own choices.
- ☐ I can learn to be content.
- ☐ I can guard my heart.
- ☐ I can live at peace as far as it depends on me.
- ☐ I can build a good life now.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  *"For each one should carry his own load."*
- ☐ Philippians 4:11
  *"I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances."*
- ☐ Proverbs 4:23
  *"Guard your heart with all diligence, for from it flow springs of life."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Joy not waiting: Each day, write one thing that brought you joy that did not depend on your parents.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Philippians 4:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I have learned to be content, whatever my parents do.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Forgiveness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- [ ] Count the cost. Write what waiting for their change has cost you.
- [ ] Divide the control. List what is yours and what is theirs.
- [ ] Plan one good thing. Schedule something you enjoy this week.
- [ ] Set a limit if needed. Decide what contact is healthy for you and communicate it calmly.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't be happy until my parents change": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Joy not waiting |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't be happy until my parents change.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I have waited a long time for them to change. Help me place my hope in You, release what is not mine to control, and build a good life with the joy You give. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*